

Agentic Recovery for Lightweight Vision-Language-Action Policies

Author Names Omitted for Anonymous Review. Paper-ID [add your ID here]

Abstract—TODO.

I. INTRODUCTION

TODO.

II. RELATED WORK

A. Efficient Vision-Language-Action Policies

TODO cite SmolVLA [8], TinyVLA [9], OpenVLA [4], and broader robot foundation policies such as RT-1 [2] and RT-2 [11].

B. Agentic Planning and Feedback

TODO cite SayCan [1], Inner Monologue [3], Code as Policies [5], ReAct [10], and Reflexion [7]. Tie this to SemRob topics: semantic goal interpretation, policy steering, online correction, and uncertainty or failure monitoring.

C. Benchmarks and Failure-Recovery Evaluation

TODO cite LIBERO [6]. State why final success must remain the benchmark success flag rather than a wrapper-internal verifier decision.

III. METHOD

A. Base Policy and Evaluation Harness

TODO describe the fixed SmolVLA policy, observation/action interface, LIBERO or ManiSkill environment, seeds, action budgets, and logging artifacts.

B. Agentic Recovery Wrapper

TODO define planner, verifier, retry scheduler, and replan policy. Distinguish episode-level retry from subgoal-level in-episode recovery if both appear.

C. Success Semantics

TODO state explicitly: final task success is the environment benchmark success signal, e.g., `info["success"]` or `is_success`. Wrapper verifier predicates are used only for control decisions such as continue, retry, or replan.

IV. EXPERIMENTS

A. Setup

TODO list suites, task IDs, episodes per task, compute environment, simulator versions, policy checkpoint, and action-step protocol.

TABLE I

POLICY-ONLY BASELINE REPRODUCTION ON LIBERO. FILL WITH FINAL PAPER-SCALE NUMBERS ONLY.

Condition	Goal	Object	Spatial	Long	Avg
Policy-only	TODO	TODO	TODO	TODO	TODO
Reference	TODO	TODO	TODO	TODO	TODO

TABLE II

AGENTIC RECOVERY ABLATION. KEEP ALL CONDITIONS MATCHED BY SEEDS, BASE POLICY, AND ACTION BUDGET UNLESS EXPLICITLY STATED.

Condition	Episodes	Success	Recovery	Retries
Policy-only	TODO	TODO	–	–
Agentic retry	TODO	TODO	TODO	TODO
Agentic replan	TODO	TODO	TODO	TODO

B. Policy-Only Baseline

TODO summarize the current routed SmolVLA baseline and cite the local artifact paths in the camera-ready or supplement, not in the blinded submission.

C. Recovery Results

TODO compare `policy_only`, `agentic_retry`, and, if ready, `agentic_replan`. Report recovery-after-failure, retries per episode, latency, and failure categories.

V. DISCUSSION

TODO explain when recovery helps, when it fails, and what this says about semantic reasoning around lightweight VLA policies.

VI. LIMITATIONS

TODO include limited task coverage, simulator-only evidence, verifier dependence, no weight updates, possible extra action budget, and no real robot claim unless real evidence is added.

VII. CONCLUSION

TODO one paragraph: what was tested, strongest measured result, and why the wrapper is useful as an evaluation and recovery layer for lightweight VLA policies.

REFERENCES

- [1] Michael Ahn, Anthony Brohan, Noah Brown, Yevgen Chebotar, Omar Cortes, Byron David, Chelsea Finn, Chuyuan Fu, Keerthana Gopalakrishnan, Karol Hausman, Alexander Herzog, Daniel Ho, Jasmine Hsu, Brian

- Ichter, Alex Irpan, Eric Jang, Rosario Jauregui Ruano, Kyle Jeffrey, Sally Jesmonth, Nikhil Joshi, Ryan Julian, Dmitry Kalashnikov, Yuheng Kuang, Isabel Lee, Sergey Levine, Yao Lu, Linda Luu, Carolina Parada, Peter Pastor, John Quiambao, Kanishka Rao, Jarek Rettinghouse, Diego Reyes, Pierre Sermanet, Nicolas Sievers, Clayton Tan, Alexander Toshev, Vincent Vanhoucke, Fei Xia, Ted Xiao, Peng Xu, Sichun Xu, Mengyuan Yan, and Andy Zeng. Do as i can, not as i say: Grounding language in robotic affordances. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2204.01691*, 2022.
- [2] Anthony Brohan, Noah Brown, Justice Carbajal, Yevgen Chebotar, Xi Chen, Krzysztof Choromanski, Tianli Ding, Danny Driess, Avinava Dubey, Chelsea Finn, Pete Florence, Chuyuan Fu, Montse Gonzalez Arenas, Keerthana Gopalakrishnan, Kehang Han, Karol Hausman, Alexander Herzog, Jasmine Hsu, Brian Ichter, Alex Irpan, Nikhil Joshi, Ryan Julian, Dmitry Kalashnikov, Yuheng Kuang, Isabel Lee, Sergey Levine, Yao Lu, Henryk Michalewski, Igor Mordatch, Karl Pertsch, Kanishka Rao, Krista Reymann, Michael Ryoo, Grecia Salazar, Pannag Sanketi, Pierre Sermanet, Jaspier Singh, Anikait Singh, Radu Soricut, Huang Tran, Vincent Vanhoucke, Quan Vuong, Ayzaan Wahid, Stefan Welker, Paul Wohlhart, Jialin Wu, Fei Xia, Ted Xiao, Peng Xu, Sichun Xu, Tianhe Yu, and Brianna Zitkovich. RT-1: Robotics transformer for real-world control at scale. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2212.06817*, 2022.
- [3] Wenlong Huang, Fei Xia, Ted Xiao, Harris Chan, Jacky Liang, Pete Florence, Andy Zeng, Jonathan Tompson, Igor Mordatch, Yevgen Chebotar, Pierre Sermanet, Noah Brown, Tomas Jackson, Linda Luu, Sergey Levine, Karol Hausman, and Brian Ichter. Inner monologue: Embodied reasoning through planning with language models. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2207.05608*, 2022.
- [4] Moo Jin Kim, Karl Pertsch, Siddharth Karamcheti, Ted Xiao, Ashwin Balakrishna, Suraj Nair, Rafael Rafailov, Ethan Foster, Grace Lam, Pannag Sanketi, Quan Vuong, Thomas Kollar, Benjamin Burchfiel, Russ Tedrake, Dorsa Sadigh, Sergey Levine, Percy Liang, and Chelsea Finn. OpenVLA: An open-source vision-language-action model. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2406.09246*, 2024.
- [5] Jacky Liang, Wenlong Huang, Fei Xia, Peng Xu, Karol Hausman, Brian Ichter, Pete Florence, and Andy Zeng. Code as policies: Language model programs for embodied control. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2209.07753*, 2022.
- [6] Bo Liu, Yifeng Zhu, Chongkai Gao, Yihao Feng, Qiang Liu, Yuke Zhu, and Peter Stone. LIBERO: Benchmarking knowledge transfer for lifelong robot learning. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2023.
- [7] Noah Shinn, Federico Cassano, Ashwin Gopinath, Karthik Narasimhan, and Shunyu Yao. Reflexion: Language agents with verbal reinforcement learning. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2303.11366*, 2023.
- [8] Mustafa Shukor et al. SmolVLA: A vision-language-action model for affordable and efficient robotics. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.01844*, 2025.
- [9] Junjie Wen, Yichen Zhu, Jinming Li, Minjie Zhu, Kun Tang, Zhiyuan Xu, Yifeng Qian, Yunlei Shen, Fei Wang, and Chunyuan Tang. TinyVLA: Towards fast, data-efficient vision-language-action models for robotic manipulation. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2409.12514*, 2024.
- [10] Shunyu Yao, Jeffrey Zhao, Dian Yu, Nan Du, Izhak Shafran, Karthik Narasimhan, and Yuan Cao. ReAct: Synergizing reasoning and acting in language models. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2210.03629*, 2022.
- [11] Brianna Zitkovich, Tianhe Yu, Sichun Xu, Peng Xu, Ted Xiao, Fei Xia, Jialin Wu, Paul Wohlhart, Stefan Welker, Ayzaan Wahid, Quan Vuong, Vincent Vanhoucke, Huang Tran, Radu Soricut, Anikait Singh, Jaspier Singh, Pierre Sermanet, Pannag Sanketi, Grecia Salazar, Michael Ryoo, Krista Reymann, Kanishka Rao, Karl Pertsch, Igor Mordatch, Henryk Michalewski, Yao Lu, Sergey Levine, Isabel Lee, Yuheng Kuang, Dmitry Kalashnikov, Ryan Julian, Nikhil Joshi, Alex Irpan, Brian Ichter, Alexander Herzog, Jasmine Hsu, Karol Hausman, Kehang Han, Keerthana Gopalakrishnan, Pete Florence, Chelsea Finn, Chuyuan Fu, Montse Gonzalez Arenas, Tianli Ding, Danny Driess, Avinava Dubey, Krzysztof Choromanski, Xi Chen, Yevgen Chebotar, Justice Carbajal, Noah Brown, and Anthony Brohan. RT-2: Vision-language-action models transfer web knowledge to robotic control. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2307.15818*, 2023.